John Colacioppo

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EDUCATION

University of Connecticut (UConn) - Expected Graduation: May 2029 | Storrs, CT
EXPECTED B.S. in Mechanical Engineering • Minor: Aerospace Engineering
GPA: 3.32/4.0

PROJECTS & RESEARCH

Formula SAE (FSAE) — Composite Anti-Intrusion Plate Design UConn Formula SAE Team, 2025–Present

- Collaborating with a multidisciplinary team to design a carbon fiber anti-intrusion plate for SES compliance.
- Modeled the anti-intrusion plate geometry in SOLIDWORKS and defined custom orthotropic materials in ANSYS ACP (Pre), optimizing ply orientation for weight reduction and structural performance.
- Achieved a projected 78% weight reduction versus the baseline design through ANSYS ACP simulation, with real-world validation testing planned to confirm structural performance.

Science Research Course — Coats' Disease (rare retinal disorder affecting blood vessels in the eye)

- Conducted independent research focused on Coats' disease to better understand the causes.
- Coordinated outreach with multiple foundations and designed an online survey to gather data nationwide.
- Analyzed responses to identify patterns and insights; submitted research paper to Regeneron STS and JSHS, and presented findings at WESEF.

Eagle Scout Service Project — Local Food Pantry Storage Renovation

- Led a team of 15+ volunteers to design and build new shelving, improving storage capacity and organization.
- Met with town officials, secured approvals and funding, aligned on requirements, and managed project logistics.
- Applied project management skills to plan, schedule, budget, and execute tasks including construction, painting, and facility upgrades.

LEADERSHIP, ACTIVITIES & HONORS

- **Boy Scouts of America (BSA)** (2013 - 2025)— Eagle Scout; Order of the Arrow (National Honor Society); Junior Assistant Scoutmaster; Senior Patrol Leader *(Mentored younger scouts and guided advancement)*
- **Swimming** (2013 - 2025)— Varsity Team Captain (Boys); Varsity Team Manager (Girls); Club Swimming (YWCA Middies; Harrison Recreation) *Directed team practices, supported coaches, and organized team events.*

SKILLS

- **CAD Software:** SOLIDWORKS, Onshape
- **Engineering Software:** ANSYS (ACP, Mechanical, SpaceClaim), Slicer Software (Bambu Studio, PrusaSlicer)
- **Fabrication & Shop:** 3D Printers (FDM & SLA), Hand Tools, Power Tools, Shop Safety
- **Project & Research:** Experimental Design, Survey Methodology, Data Analysis, Project Management

INTERESTS

Aerospace systems and defense, propulsion, structural design & thermal protection, CAD & prototyping, advanced manufacturing, woodworking, 3D printing, competitive swimming, community service.